

The GoodDay Gazette

"All the inventory that's fit to print."

FRIDAY, AUGUST 21, 2026

REPORTING PERIOD: AUGUST 14 - AUGUST 20, 2026

EIGHT PAGES

THE FRONT PAGE

P.1 · Vol. I No. 15

FINISH THE JOB

The Whole Company Went to Austin to Finish the Job, and Came Back With Seven Demos

Three days at WeWork Barton Springs under a one-line theme. Both standing meetings went dark, the Notion record is the thinnest this paper has covered — and Thursday's wrap-up put a PO configurator, a 135,000-order sale and an agent-scoring harness on the screen in one sitting.

BY THE GAZETTE DESK · SOURCES: ATX ONSITE WRAP-UP RECORDING (AUG 20), #GOODDAY-TEAM, #GO-TO-MARKET, #MERCHANT-SUCCESS, NOTION

The FY26 Austin on-site ran Tuesday through Thursday at 801 Barton Springs Road under the theme Kyle Hency set in advance: "Finish the job." Tuesday was State of the Business and Product Vision plus an AMA, nine to two. Wednesday brought an accounting walk-through in the morning, functional working sessions for go-to-market and Merchant Success in the afternoon, and the full-team dinner at The Well Bouldin. Thursday closed with a wrap-up presentation from eleven to noon, followed — for the go-to-market team — by a three-hour pipeline cleanup that River Crawford joined remotely. That wrap-up hour is

the most substantive record of the week, because it is the only part of the on-site that was recorded and shared: Meagan Herfkens Hency posted the link into #goodday-team at 10:55 on Thursday morning. What the rest of the three days left behind, or failed to, is on P.8.

Seven demos ran back to back. Seth Horton opened with a PO configurator that lets a merchant customise purchase order templates — adding and removing fields, dropping in custom content and logos — with per-merchant template defaults and sales-order customisation queued next. He had already posted a working build into #goodday-team that morning; it

THE WEEK BY THE NUMBERS

Pylon tickets opened	~240
Go-lives, August to date	7
Releases cut / shipped	8 / 7
PRs merged (Weave)	136
Bug share of output	47.7%
Gong calls, all desks	69
Demos at the wrap-up	7

drew four fire reactions before the session started. **Noel Klein** followed with the number of the week: Lola's Black Friday event produced **135,000 orders**, past what the stress tests had predicted, and held because the team put a "fast lane" in front of it to stop the infrastructure saturating. **Willy Husted** and others walked returns onboarding out of its corner — the implementation had been hard-coded to ShipHero, and now works against other warehouse systems, Deposco first.

The back half was about being able to see things. **Scott** demonstrated prefetching and client-side caching to make the app feel faster. **Rob Hatfield** showed a front-end monitoring dashboard that finally gives GoodDay visibility into how users navigate and how long pages actually take — which, following a week in which four separate incidents were diagnosed only after a merchant reported them, is the

more consequential of the two. And **Ashwin Pai** closed with an evaluation harness for the AI agents: a way to score the recon agent against different question types and track whether it is getting better or worse over time. Sai Ancha keeps feeding it data. The full rundown, with chapter timings and owners, is on P.5.

Everything else in the company's formal record simply did not happen. There is no All Hands page for the week and no Voice of the Merchant page — both exist in Notion as unfilled templates, every field reading TBD (P.8). The commercial week ran in parallel: Toccin held its kickoff Tuesday, #go-to-market spent Monday scrubbing the Q3 forecast down to ten or fifteen deals, and two prospects walked — both citing finance depth (P.2). Hunter Leeming's Monday post put Troubadour Goods live and the August tally at **seven go-lives**. Pylon,

Ticket volume climbed to ~240 (Pylon 9793–10032) from last issue's ~213 — the heaviest week in the fifteen-issue series, roughly 19% above the previous high of 202. Troubadour Goods alone opened 20 in its first week live.

LEAD II • 47.7 PER CENT BUGS

Half the Week's Output Was Bug Work. Then a 25-Unit Gap Turned Into 9,983.

Weave's Monday scorecard showed output up 41.7% and 136 PRs merged — against a feature-to-bug split of 46.9% to **47.7%**. Dave Wardell did not spin it: "Pretty brutal to be confronted with this, even worse than my gut would have said... We've gotta do better. Q3 is going to be focused on finishing and delivering. Starts now." Rob Hatfield's caveat within the hour was that the ratio measures model-estimated PR effort, not hours.

Tuesday made the case for the number. Seth Horton traced a confirmed 25-unit Cloth & Paper discrepancy to **9,983 stuck ledger rows across 1,944 SKUs**, every one reading success. The handler failed the first event it ever received and every one after. No alert fired (P.4, P.5).

LEAD III • SPLIT BRAIN

The Release That Half-Landed

v0.142.7 was cut Thursday at 10:02 a.m. to fix Excel-unreadable PO numbers. It failed. Five services — web-api, api-external, ops portal, temporal-worker and worker — never deployed, leaving production running two versions at once while App Engine, jobs, Shopify and the database migration all went green. Attempt one stalled 44 minutes in Cloud Run provisioning; attempt two died in under a minute with zero application logs (P.5).

ALSO INSIDE

What Else Made the Paper

Promixx ruled GoodDay out over a £50M ceiling. River's read: right answer, wrong reason (P.2).

Items v2 got a hard mid-September date, and Parent Items got a deprecation notice (P.4, P.6).

Sarah Flint got GoodDay's first-ever Moda Express connection, ahead of a September 1 NetSuite exit (P.8).

Ser Rekonatot reversed itself four times, and was right to. The people who made it do so are the story (P.7).

"Excited to see everyone tomorrow at Hotel Magdalena for our August 26 ATX On-site! Thanks in advance to everyone for the effort, thoughtfulness and preparation."

— KYLE HENCY, MON AUG 17 • #GOODDAY-TEAM

TWO LOSSES, ONE REASON

£50 Million Was the Stated Objection. Multi-Entity Was the Real One.

Promixx passed on GoodDay because its buyer thinks the company will outgrow the product. River Crawford's read is that GoodDay already runs larger brands — and that the actual blocker is three legal entities and multi-currency. HubSpot gained a Loss Reason Detail field the same day.

SOURCES: #SALES-SUPPORT, #GO-TO-MARKET, 9 GONG CALLS (KELLEY FLATLEY, KYLE HENCY)

Jon at Promixx wrote a rejection letter good enough to publish. "I was very impressed with this product and loved the feature of it being an app through Shopify," he told River Crawford — before the turn: "I believe that GoodDay ticks the boxes for many features which we would benefit from, but I feel that it would be limiting to when we scale in the next 3 years to £50+million revenue." River brought it back to #go-to-market on Tuesday with the diagnosis attached: "while I think he's ruling us out for the wrong reason, I'm not sure we actually want to push this one right now anyway." GoodDay runs significantly larger brands than Promixx. What GoodDay does not yet run well is three separate entities across the UK, EU and US on multiple currencies — which is exactly Promixx's shape, alongside Amazon FBA in three regions, Amazon Vendor Central, three Shopify Plus storefronts, TikTok, SPS EDI into Walmart, Meijer, GNC and Vitamin Shoppe, and three independent 3PLs. River's plan is to rebut the size objection so it does not calcify into a myth, then circle back when multi-entity ships. Meagan Herfkens Hency had Breeze log the whole thing as a note on the company record, and the same afternoon announced a new HubSpot field: "if we loose because of a feature gap, or som other reason worth noting, please take a second to fill this

in so we can reference for future opportunities."

It was that kind of week for the finance roadmap. Left On Friday's deal is now openly gated on it — three-way match at end-2026, multi-entity and multi-currency in Summer 2027, Xero probably before a native ledger. Bombshell Sportswear spent sixty-six minutes with Kelley Flatley and Dave Wardell on multi-stage co-manufacturing and then pushed back on adopting a Q4 build before it reaches general availability in January or February. And Tushy, which River liked and which liked GoodDay, had already signed with Tether after coming off Extensiv. "But she really liked GoodDay!" River reported — and then extracted the consolation prize: the contact says she is well connected and asked for a one-pager she can hand to other operational leads shopping for ERP.

Monday was a forecast scrub. Kyle Hency had the team update close dates across Best Case, Most Likely and Commit and load every live deal with a 50%-or-better chance of closing before the end of October, then said the quiet part: "we'll use this list to isolate 10-15 deals that are most important and that we're going to hack at this week when we have downtime." MeUndies is the one with a clock on it — four follow-ups out of Kyle's Friday email, an

PIPELINE NOTES

Sales-hosted Gong calls	9
Priority deals isolated	10–15
MeUndies close target	6 wks
WelleCo annual revenue	~\$25M
Incumbent ERPs targeted	8

DISPLACEMENT LIST

Kyle handed Meagan the Loop brand list with an ERP column and named the systems worth displacing: AIMS360, ApparelMagic, Blue Cherry, Cin7, Full Circle, iSync, Linnworks, Xorosoft. Evan Smith replied with nine RLM accounts he is working. Meagan's follow-up trimmed it: "heads up Mara Hoffman closed Down."

HOUSEKEEPING

Latham Companies arrived as two duplicate "Little English" records and no record at all for 3 Marthas. Evan confirmed the parent structure — one company, three brands, three separate GoodDay instances — and rebuilt the records so James Hargett's brand-level discovery has somewhere to land.

Implementation Blueprint due inside two weeks, and a directive to "build a game plan to try to close them in the next 6 weeks."

PROSPECT • WELLECO

A \$25M Brand Where Forecasting Is the Whole Deal

River's Wednesday call with WelleCo produced the cleanest qualification of the week. The Australian brand runs Shopify stores in the US, EU, UK and AU plus B2B, and would happily consolidate onto Shopify Markets if migration weren't the obstacle. Their current system already does most of what GoodDay demoed — so the only reason to switch is inventory planning. "They specifically said that if we can do this better than what they're doing today in Excel, they'd be very interested in moving forward." River had already told them the planning module is an expensive add-on: "and they still wanted to see it!" Four finance questions went to Dave — Xero timeline, multi-currency POs, batch-level tracking alongside FIFO, and how COGS moves during transition.

PROSPECT • RELAB SKIN

The BOM Call That Started With a Correction

A new skincare brand — roughly \$1M this year, three saleable SKUs, contract manufacturing with components shipped to CMOs — wants freight blended across split shipments from the same PO so component cost doesn't swing. Kelley Flatley closed that door on Thursday: "this is not how our product works- we do FIFO COGs so if the shipping is wildly different that is going to be reflected but that is more accurate of their true picture of COGs." River floated re-deriving an average in reporting; Kelley: "that will get messy and not flow through to their accounting." Kyle trimmed the deep dive from 45 minutes to 30 — "if good fit, offer start-up pricing" — and it landed on August 31.

INBOUND • SET ACTIVE

The Founder Who Keeps Posting About Ops

Set Active's founder posted another story about operations problems on Monday. Kelley Flatley flagged it for Kyle inside half an hour and noted the cadence: "This is honestly like one story she's posting like every 3-4 weeks at this point..." Meagan sent a LinkedIn message on Kyle's behalf to the founder and the COO. Elsewhere, Criquet put three of five workstreams through a review and kept four — deprioritising only the MCP set-up — with the Blueprint flagged as "likely the most critical part." Rebecca Minkoff, a closed-lost deal, replied personally to an intro request River admits he sent by accident.

GONG LEDGER • SALES DESK • AUGUST 14 – 20, 2026 • 9 CALLS

DATE	ACCOUNT	HOST	MIN	SUBSTANCE
Aug 14	Thousand	Kyle Hency	28	Renewal landed — flat core platform fee until \$20M revenue, six integrations included, \$50/mo per additional connection.
Aug 14	Symmitri	Kyle Hency	36	Jonathan Poma exploring a personal AI layer — morning briefs, commitments, VIP routing — on top of GoodDay's open API.
Aug 14	Crew Finance orbit	Kyle Hency	25	Brad Schroeder partnership model for outsourced FP&A; Claude-built finance apps at ~\$175/hr with GoodDay margin. Fair Harbor first target.
Aug 17	Ecomm Cowboy	Kyle Hency	12	Podcast prep, not a deal call.
Aug 17	Bombshell Sportswear	Kelley Flatley	66	Multi-stage co-manufacturing requirements — WIP, per-stage costing, trim at contractor, three-way match. Merchant flagged timing risk of pre-GA adoption.
Aug 17	Lalo	Kelley Flatley	30	Discovery on replacing SyncSeven — AMS East/West, SPS EDI, dropship partners, split-ship POs, BOM assembly. Pricing walked.
Aug 17	Left On Friday	Kelley Flatley	26	Finance-roadmap objection handling; onboarding fee flexibility and data-portability language offered.
Aug 19	Untamed Petals	Kelley Flatley	27	Kickoff — accessories brand replacing Stocky. Shopify D2C + B2B, ShipHero, Nordstrom dropship via Miracle, Route returns. Run by Hunter, James and David.

DATE	ACCOUNT	HOST	MIN	SUBSTANCE
Aug 19	Three Nails	Kelley Flatley	27	Kickoff — \$9M brand targeting \$20M with a Tim Tebow launch. Pre-holiday go-live contingent on the Geodis build.

"I believe that GoodDay ticks the boxes for many features which we would benefit from, but I feel that it would be limiting to when we scale in the next 3 years to £50+million revenue."

— JON, PROMIXX, QUOTED BY RIVER CRAWFORD • WED AUG 19 • #GO-TO-MARKET

TEN BRANDS AND A SANDBOX

SPS Commerce Is Opening Doors in the Twin Cities. NuOrder Is Asking Minnow for Something Nobody Else Needed.

Evan Smith made his move to Partnerships official this week and immediately produced a ten-brand Minneapolis target list with in-person intros attached — while defending one merchant against a sandbox requirement GoodDay has never been asked for before.

SOURCES: #PARTNERSHIPS, 6 GONG CALLS (EVAN SMITH)

Evan Smith told Mario Rivera at Cart.com on Monday that he has formally moved to Partnerships, and by Wednesday afternoon the channel had the receipt: a ten-brand Twin Cities prospecting list built jointly with SPS Commerce, who are arranging in-person introductions for Hunter Leeming's visit and confirming the trip directly. Evan annotated every line. UNRL, Waggle, Oliver Cabell, Booe and Lucy & Co. are current customers on one side or the other; Duke Cannon is on Brightpearl; Booe runs Luminous; Eyebobs sits on NetSuite with nothing sold in over a year; Swannies Golf is analytics-only on Apparel Magic. The one he underlined was Storm Creek — "Tested with us multiple times. This would be a good lead for us." That was half the list. SPS was working the other half the next day.

The friction came from a different partner. Hunter reported Wednesday that NuOrder is requiring Minnow to stand up a sandbox account — something GoodDay has not been asked to do for any other merchant — and that Minnow has no NuOrder account manager, so the request arrived through general support with nobody to escalate to. Evan took it in one line: "This shouldn't be the case. Let me

reach out to NuOrder." Unresolved at press time.

Meagan Herfkens Hency opened the week with an audit rather than a target list. Five won accounts had self-reported as partner referrals while arriving as inbound leads — BISBY and Little English, 12th Tribe, VEE Collective and Toccin — and she asked Evan to back-audit the February-to-July sheet the same day. He did, by lunchtime: "Yes they did- I audited them all." He holds intro emails for BISBY, Little English and 12th Tribe. VEE Collective was the one still unvalidated when the thread closed.

On the integration side, the Orderful roster closed at three. Evan needed every customer waiting on the build so all could be scoped for document coverage in a single pass; Margaux is scoped and needs three 800-series documents, TomboyX is later this year, and James Hargett added Kismet inside a minute. And in the Loop bi-weekly on Wednesday, the partner map got a full pass: a Shopify public app listing, EDI coverage across SPS, Crstl and Oracle, ShipHero on the WMS side, Ryder fixed via the Fulfill order connector, a Dish referral, an RLM migration push, and Tenoré's Loop go-live around mid-October. Unreal was recorded as lost — on finance and

PARTNER DESK TALLIES

Partnership Gong calls	6
Twin Cities brands listed	10
Attribution audit: accounts	5
— still unvalidated	1
Orderful roster	3
Margaux 800-series docs	3

REFERRALS IN

Jon Reese at Dwight Funding brought two. **Stix Golf** qualifies strongly — 90–95% DTC, QuickBooks, Aeronet, Clear Freight and GoBolt. **Credo Beauty** does not; it is a retailer.

KATANA

Richard Ainscough accepted the MCP-based interim integration for the Clayton & Crume build, with a direct API wanted long-term and a Slack notification rollout requested. Event co-hosting scoped into 2027.

accounting depth, the same objection that shaped page two.

PROSPECT · MARLEYLILLY

A \$40M Brand With a Fully Custom Stack

Kelly Owens brought Evan a genuinely unusual shape on Thursday the 14th: a fully custom WMS, a personalization ERP, and a "source SKU" model underneath it all. The requirement is API-first, and the indicated budget was roughly \$2,500 a month against a \$40M business. It is the sort of account that tests whether GoodDay's open API is a product or a promise — the same question Jonathan Poma is poking at from the other direction over on page two.

EVENTS

The Calendar Cart.com Is Filling

Monday's Cart.com call produced a co-hosting slate rather than a pipeline entry: a Chargers suite, a ShopTalk Fall rooftop, Manifest, and a J.P. Morgan event in Austin. Cart also bid on EBY's fulfilment. Elsewhere the Flagship RTL bi-weekly ran Thursday for thirty minutes — Gong captured no summary for it, so the Gazette is recording only that it happened.

GONG LEDGER · PARTNERSHIPS · AUGUST 14 – 20, 2026 · 6 CALLS

DATE	COUNTERPARTY	MIN	SUBSTANCE
Aug 14	Marleylilly	31	Custom WMS plus personalization ERP on a "source SKU" model; needs API-first. ~\$2.5K/mo indicated on a \$40M business.
Aug 17	Cart.com	20	Evan's formal move to Partnerships. Cart bid on EBY fulfilment; co-hosting Chargers suite, ShopTalk Fall rooftop, Manifest, Austin J.P. Morgan event.
Aug 17	Katana	21	MCP-based interim integration accepted for Clayton & Crume; direct API wanted long-term; Slack rollup requested; 2027 events scoped.
Aug 19	Dwight Funding	13	Referral qualification — Stix Golf a strong fit, Credo Beauty weak as a retailer.
Aug 19	Loop Returns	21	Partner map — Shopify app listing, EDI via SPS/Crstl/Oracle, ShipHero, Ryder fixed via Fulfill connector, Dish referral, RLM push, Tenoré live ~mid-Oct, Unreal lost.
Aug 20	Flagship RTL	30	Recurring 3PL bi-weekly. No summary captured in Gong.

"This shouldn't be the case. Let me reach out to NuOrder."

— EVAN SMITH, WED AUG 19 · #PARTNERSHIPS

FIFTY-FOUR CALLS, TWO HUNDRED AND FORTY TICKETS

The Heaviest Support Week on Record, and Nine Go-Lives Stacked Behind It

Pylon took ~240 tickets — more than any week in this paper’s history — while the team ran fifty-four calls, shipped two Claude skills, unblocked Greenmark, and committed to real-time inventory accuracy at Prepared Hero by August 31.

SOURCES: #MERCHANT-SUCCESS, #SERS-TAVERN, PYLON, 54 GONG CALLS

The go-live board is the densest it has been. Eric Javits has September 1 for POs and shipments, gated on Bergen, with full operational readiness waiting on a Bergen-to-Shopify inventory sync targeted September 10. The Perfect Jean is next week, blocked on shipment sync failures into ITB and Capacity. Canopy proposed Tuesday, contingent on a system-wide inventory sync and an operational pause. Rowing Blazers is Monday or Tuesday pending cart integration fixes. Local Eclectic is one to two weeks out with Logiwa testing the sole remaining blocker. Guizio holds September with a parallel Bergen Shopify location and a phased RLM cutover. BeamRoom cut over on Thursday. Equip Foods slipped to September deliberately, to avoid taking tier-kit and sync problems into peak season. And Sarah Flint is racing a September 1 NetSuite renewal on GoodDay's first-ever Moda Express connection.

The week's hardest commitment was made on Thursday. David Ortiz took Prepared Hero twice — a forty-nine-minute weekly sync on virtual and physical kits, then a thirty-minute escalation with Dave Wardell on the call about inventory valuation gaps. Recon discrepancies are concentrated on Amazon and Didadi dropship. What came out of it: a cost-adjustment

template, and real-time inventory accuracy by **August 31**, with retrospective July 31 balances explicitly demoted to secondary. Shipfusion was confirmed feasible in the same conversation.

Two Claude skills shipped out of the team itself, which is new. Hunter Leeming published a WMS inventory analysis skill on Friday the 14th — drop in a WMS report and a Shopify export by location and it compares against both sellable and on-hand — with Greenmark sample inputs attached. It drew the best reaction set of the week (five checkmarks, four thank-yous, four fires) and Willy Husted is working with Hunter to make it a native part of WMS testing in the UI. On Thursday David Ortiz pushed a second one to the subteam: it copies GoodDay's Drive templates into a customer's existing folder under Won, creating the folder if it does not exist, and renames every file with the customer name.

Greenmark itself got unblocked on Friday after the production credentials turned out to have gone to spam. Willy stood the connection up on the Troubadour store instance, then verified the flip: available had been minus one, a plus-one adjustment succeeded, and both available and on-hand settled at zero. "GoodDay writes to that location are unblocked."

PYLON SNAPSHOT

Tickets opened	~240
Issue range	9793–10032
Prior series high	202
Troubadour Goods	20
The Perfect Jean	13
Cloth and Paper	10
Canopy / Over the Moon	9 ea.
Draw And Fade	8
Eby / Laundry Sauce / Duvin	7 ea.

Roughly a quarter of the week's tickets were inventory reconciliation and WMS-to-GoodDay-to-Shopify sync. About thirty were PO upload, CSV and template friction. A distinct cutover cluster included a go-live risk assessment for an August 25 launch and paired "Disable Inventory Push, Monday Aug 17th" tickets. Three tickets were logged as positive feedback.

GO-LIVE BOARD

- **BeamRoom** — cut over Thu Aug 20
- **Canopy** — proposed Tuesday

Elsewhere David set up Sauna Box's b2b field mapping for ShipHero from an airport gate while waiting to board — "Just set it up while waiting to board" — and then wrote up the God Mode path for Matt Wardell, who had never done WMS field mapping before.

The governance news is the one merchants will feel. On Thursday afternoon Scott told the channel GoodDay is "prepping to deprecate

Parent items and going whole hog on Items v2," and asked the whole team to work exclusively from /items and flag gaps. Hunter pushed immediately on merchant impact — would the nav entry go, and when? Scott confirmed the plan is to retire the parent items pages entirely, not merely hide the link, with no date yet: get Merchant Success consistent first, then publish a merchant timeline "with

- **Rowing Blazers** — Mon/Tue
- **The Perfect Jean** — next week
- **Eric Javits** — Sept 1 / Sept 10
- **Sarah Flint** — before Sept 1
- **Local Eclectic** — 1–2 weeks
- **Guizio** — September
- **Equip Foods** — September (slipped)

DOCUMENTATION

The Lot Rebalancing Spec, and "The New AI Slop"

Troy Lowe posted the finished rule set for lot rebalancing on Wednesday — redistributing available inventory within a segment to heal negative balances, moving remaining negatives to the canonical default lot, reducing duplicate default lots — worked out with Dave Wardell and filed as GD-13375. Thursday, Dave rejected the document's language wholesale, listing eleven terms he could not parse across four stages: "backed" and "unbacked," "claiming lot," "cures," "ride onto," "sub-state intact," "carrying a loss." His verdict has become the week's most-quoted line: "Claude going absolutely crazy with random meaningless buzz words... I feel like this is the new AI slop, noticing it everywhere now." Troy walked James Hargett through the basics in person instead.

PROCESS

Context Belongs in the Ticket

Twice this week Dave Wardell drew the same line. On Friday, on a DCL managed-fulfilment locations request: "any key context like that needs to be in the ticket when making a feature request, not buried in the threads. This works, we will prioritize." On Monday, on transfer-order custom fields: "ATC = bugs, bad data, etc. This should route through me when there is no live/active project being worked for it." James Hargett supplied the missing why — the merchant tags transfer type, replenishment versus new product launch, to prioritise — and conceded the mislabel: "my bad for assuming there I guess." Both got scoped the same day they got context.

ONSITE

State of Merchant Success

Hunter Leeming revised the onsite agenda on Tuesday: two to four for open working time, four to five-thirty for State of Merchant Success, with a request that the team prioritise the latter — partly status, largely a brainstorm on how the team is doing and how to improve. Two artefacts came out of it. A "GoodDay Knowledge Gaps 8.19" document went up Thursday morning, and a Drive folder of Granola notes from every session followed an hour later. The travel was less dignified: Matt Pham landed at midnight — "Heading to airport, get in at midnight, see yall tmrw!"

From The Sers Tavern · Merchant Triage: The Channel The Team Uses To Diagnose, In One Pass. Fifty-five threads and roughly four hundred messages this week, every one of them a person putting a merchant problem in front of Ser Rekonat and, increasingly, asking Macroscopic to check the answer. Thread starters: **Seth Horton 15, Matt Wardell 10, Scott 8, David Ortiz 8, Harish Chandramowli 4, Hunter Leeming 4, Tim Kauer 2**, with one each from Troy Lowe, Willy Husted and Matt Pham. James Hargett started none and still decided one of the week's threads.

TAVERN · CLOTH & PAPER

The Canary, and Five Corrections

TAVERN · PREPARED HERO

The Zero That Locked the Door

TAVERN · DUVIN & HALFDAYS

Eighty-Eight Milliseconds, and 827

Seth Horton's Tuesday thread ran to fifty-nine replies and is the best record the company has of how this channel actually works. Ser's first attempt died on an argument-size guard. Its second blamed Shopify, then reversed to ShipHero, then reversed again when Seth posted a screenshot of order #647018 marked Fulfilled and Delivered — GoodDay had received the webhook and failed to persist it. Seth then corrected Ser's scoping twice, excluding The Intention Box and subscription SKUs, taking the count from 1,977 SKUs down to 1,944 and 14,187 rows down to 9,983. "9801311 is a subscription. Dont make the assumption it is not." Ser's own summary of the failure mode is the sentence to keep: "The pipeline believes it succeeded. No alert fired. On-hand was never decremented."

David Ortiz refused Ser's first answer outright — "I am challenging this below because GoodDay has not been pushing any adjustments to Shopify for this item" — and was right. Ser conceded: "Your challenge is correct." The real picture was three failures compounding. GoodDay's export forces a negative available up to zero; the publish guard then compares zero to a last-published value of zero, recorded August 7, calls it unchanged, and suppresses the Shopify call indefinitely. Meanwhile Stord's WMS had written three thousand-plus units straight into Shopify, bypassing GoodDay entirely. Dave Wardell's read: "So because we last pushed 0 and then Stord overrode. We are ignoring since it is still 0 in GD... We need to compare to what Shopify has at least on a daily basis."

Rows

Matt Wardell reported a Duvin receipt that arrived, matched twenty SKUs and 739 units correctly, and then died on a unique-constraint collision with a second Duvin receipt eighty-eight milliseconds later. A bare catch swallowed the error, Pub/Sub acknowledged, and the shipment stayed open. Ser told Matt *not* to file a ticket — GD-13175 already documents it at ten to twelve times a day with an unmerged PR. Separately, Halfdays' PO 118 accumulated **827 duplicate receiving rows** across twelve Trackstar webhook waves, none of which credited any inventory. Ser called it the most severe instance of that bug class it had seen.

GONG LEDGER · MERCHANT SUCCESS · AUGUST 14 – 20, 2026 · 54 CALLS

DATE	ACCOUNT	HOST	MIN	SUBSTANCE
Aug 14	VEE Collective / Zenfulfillment	Matt Pham	30	Making GoodDay the inventory source of truth over Pixie WMS and Zenrush; granular Pixie data and the returns flow are the blockers.
Aug 14	Internal — SPS/EDI	James Hargett	13	EDI status across Half Day, Prepared Hero, Troubadour, Canopy, Sonnebog, Guizio and Bloomingdale's; needs a system change to test new and live trading partners at once.
Aug 14	Saint Art NY	James Hargett	14	Discovery cut short by an absence and pushed to Monday; mid-October target ahead of holiday, invoicing can precede the live inventory ledger.
Aug 14	Latham Companies	Matt Pham	21	Wholesale trade-offs for 3 Marthas between Shopify B2B and GoodDay; three brands consolidating onto one Shopify instance so templates deferred.
Aug 14	Margaux	James Hargett	25	Nordstrom in-store and dropship rollout via Rithum/Orderful, HTS and custom-field sync, RFID inventory. Nordstrom EDI requirements still unclear.
Aug 14	Canopy	David Ortiz	62	Built out wholesale channels, SPS plus ad-hoc order workflow, QBO invoicing, and DCL push/allocation mapping.
Aug 14	Aaron Levine	Seth Horton	42	Platform walkthrough — POs, shipments, landed cost, Scale WMS reconciliation, custom reporting for a scaling team.
Aug 14	Clayton and Crume (internal)	Matt Pham	19	Internal debate on where customization-order filtering logic should live for the Katana API/MCP interim build. Sandbox to be stood up.
Aug 14	Aaron Levine	Seth Horton	12	Granular inventory views, pushing wholesale orders to the 3PL, PO and split-shipment best practice. Onsite support planned.
Aug 14	Minnow	Hunter Leeming	44	Split shipments, estimated and landed cost, reporting demo; OnBrand plus QuickBooks plan and historical FOB cost upload.
Aug 14	Local Eclectic	Matt Pham	56	Fixed PO import failures, clarified SKU creation between Lajua and Shopify, walked shipment and receiving. Tentative September go-live.

DATE	ACCOUNT	HOST	MIN	SUBSTANCE
Aug 14	Parasol Co	River Crawford	57	Intro and demo around a US-manufacturing shift and complex costing; segmentation, recon and PO management pitched. Demo plus pricing next.
Aug 14	Latham / Little English	James Hargett	56	Consolidating three brands onto one Shopify Plus, NuORDER wholesale, unified stack. Late-September go-live target.
Aug 14	TENÖRE	James Hargett	38	Production incoterms and vendor reliability, shipment creation, wholesale pre-book plus QBO invoicing, possible EDI — complicated by a simultaneous 3PL switch.
Aug 14	e-conolight	River Crawford	39	Post-Shopify-migration backend search; positioned as a NetSuite alternative. Finance and WMS follow-up booked.
Aug 14	Eric Javits	David Ortiz	60	Bergen integration setup, CSV versus direct sales-order entry, channel segmentation for allocation, custom discounts and shipper account numbers.
Aug 14	Almina Concept / Scale3PL	Matt Pham	10	Scale3PL keeps on-hand, GoodDay becomes source of truth; domestic wholesale shipping, pop-up outbound transfers, pre-orders flagged for later.
Aug 14	Skwala Fishing	River Crawford	35	Pre-season wholesale program breaks Shopify B2B; virtual segmentation plus pre-sale reservations pitched. 3PL's WMS still to be identified.
Aug 14	Sarah Flint	David Ortiz	24	Pre-order and backorder handling to clear the Sept 1 NetSuite exit; needs Moda answers on order tagging and fulfilment holds. ITB floated as alternate 3PL.
Aug 14	Chris Lepe	Matt Pham	10	Barcode fix confirmed live; resolved a birthday-cardigan SKU/size-run and UPC discrepancy for vendor shipments.
Aug 17	Cloth and Paper	Seth Horton	27	ShipHero field mapping (Drive URLs into ShipHero notes), freight and duty vendor-payment tracking via custom dashboards, split shipments. Subscription inventory deferred to October.
Aug 17	Line Change	David Ortiz	31	SKU uploads into Scale with block split and reassign for packing-list variances; fixed FedEx third-party shipping-method mapping for the Nashville Predators.
Aug 17	Troubadour Goods	River Crawford	7	Urgency on cutting off the old version; an urgent API-pull issue to the US warehouse to investigate. Tim travelling, so updates go async.
Aug 17	Clayton and Crume / Katana	Matt Pham	16	Phase-one Katana automation — API plus cloud skill — confirmed viable within weeks. Flowchart and process map to follow.
Aug 17	Peabody Home and Living	David Ortiz	34	ShipBob integration confirmed, inventory discrepancies traced to ShipBob processing lag. Field mapping, testing and PO creation next.
Aug 17	Ten Thousand	Hunter Leeming	15	Solved lot-date tracking for co-arriving inventory by concatenating lot and SKU into derivative lot numbers. Finance signed off.
Aug 17	Sarah Flint	David Ortiz	27	Moda data-connection issues and inventory accuracy ahead of go-live; agreed a “net new” path for existing POs to simplify data prep.
Aug 17	Almina Concept	James Hargett	45	Full process discovery — DTC plus wholesale, product creation, PO process, Deposco 3PL. Pre-orders and Nordstrom returns called out as hard cases.
Aug 17	Humankind	River Crawford	34	Solo operator moving to a faster-fashion, low-MOQ model. Follow-up in a few weeks once the factory situation firms up.
Aug 17	The Perfect Jean	David Ortiz	36	ITB and Capacity PO/shipment testing, shipment sync failures, bulk incoterms updates, received versus unreceived handling. Go-live targeted next week.
Aug 17	Eric Javits	David Ortiz	34	Sept 1 go-live for POs and shipments contingent on Bergen; full readiness gated on Bergen→Shopify inventory sync targeted Sept 10.

DATE	ACCOUNT	HOST	MIN	SUBSTANCE
Aug 17	Danielle Guizio	Matt Pham	20	New Shopify location for Bergen running parallel to RLM with a phased cutover. September go-live confirmed.
Aug 17	Local Eclectic	Matt Pham	25	Logiwa testing is the last blocker to a go-live in one to two weeks. Fulfilment process clarified; blocks and reporting Friday.
Aug 17	Ultra Pouches	River Crawford	9	Short intro — wants end-to-end Shopify plus Amazon order management. Rescheduling for a full demo.
Aug 17	Danielle Guizio	Matt Pham	31	Training on inventory channel config, transit estimates and defaults. SKU creation stays in RLM pending two-way Shopify sync.
Aug 17	Saint Art NY	James Hargett	60	Full discovery — D2C plus wholesale, multi-location inventory, POs, returns, raw materials, Shopify and QBO. Logistics and finance transitioning off a partner.
Aug 18	Toccin	Hunter Leeming	31	Kickoff replacing RLM. Phases laid out — discovery, supply chain, inventory — with vendor and location masters, style master and open POs requested.
Aug 18	BeamRoom / ShipStation	Timothy Kauer	23	GoodDay becomes inventory source of truth; ShipStation limited to B2C shipping only, not receiving. Live PO receiving and cutover set for Thursday.
Aug 18	Porte and Hall	Hunter Leeming	36	Posting-date edits and unified revenue/COGS reporting on the roadmap; Loop returns, Shopify recon auto-accept, and large inventory variances driven by FX and Deposco mapping.
Aug 18	Troubadour Goods	Hunter Leeming	27	Post-go-live cleanup — transaction errors, inventory valuation method, recon settings, PO and transfer issues. Amazon FBA and credit memos requested.
Aug 18	Canopy	Hunter Leeming	13	Virtual bundle upload and data-warehouse setup progress; duplicate SKUs and access permissions to clear. Target shipment extensions.
Aug 18	Equip Foods	Seth Horton	24	Tier kits, product SKUs and inventory sync issues pushed go-live to September to avoid peak season. UAT and training added.
Aug 18	Laundry Sauce	Timothy Kauer	39	Recon issues on virtual bundles, wrong component assignments, non-saleable inventory reporting. Auto-accept for adjustments and lock-code tracking discussed.
Aug 18	Lola Blankets	Hunter Leeming	23	Warehouse allotments and a NuOrder routing fix due Friday. Agreed GoodDay stays source of truth for financial reporting and inventory value as Lola builds BI.
Aug 19	Canopy	David Ortiz	52	WMS testing, inventory-data discrepancies, virtual bundles and non-inventory costs. Planned a system-wide sync plus operational pause with a proposed Tuesday go-live.
Aug 19	Over the Moon	Seth Horton	24	Received-inventory discrepancies, SKU versus UPC handling and Shopify fulfilment approach. Several bugs logged; testing next week.
Aug 19	Relab Skin	River Crawford	65	Spreadsheet-to-system prospect — finished goods plus components, QBO and Shopify, wholesale orders, manufacturing, future omnichannel.
Aug 19	Tushy	River Crawford	25	Skubana pain and an upcoming ERP migration; positioned Shopify-native ERP for Tushy or its network.
Aug 19	WelleCo	River Crawford	51	Strong reception on inventory, LLM PO creation and reporting — but Xero and true algorithmic forecasting are the gating requirements.
Aug 20	Prepared Hero	David Ortiz	49	Virtual and physical kits progress, PO workflows for prepaid inventory and free replacements, Amazon and Didadi dropship recon discrepancies. Shipfusion confirmed feasible.
Aug 20	Prepared Hero (escalation)	David Ortiz	30	Inventory valuation gaps with Dave Wardell on the call. Cost-adjustment template plus real-time accuracy committed by Aug 31; July 31 retro balances secondary.

DATE	ACCOUNT	HOST	MIN	SUBSTANCE
Aug 20	Rowing Blazers	Timothy Kauer	19	Go-live targeted Monday or Tuesday pending cart integration fixes; historical data and COGS upload, two-way Shopify sync timing, NuOrder wholesale.
Aug 20	BeamRoom	Timothy Kauer	32	Activated inventory, resolved product-status and Shopify sync concerns, walked manual PO receiving including damaged goods and UPC verification.
Aug 20	EBY	James Hargett	36	Self-serve month-end reports with filtering, and scoping a two-storefront Shopify model to segment wholesale inventory.

"The 25-unit gap in SKU 2113302 was just the canary."

— SER REKONALOT, TUE AUG 18 • #SERS-TAVERN

EIGHT CUT, SEVEN SHIPPED

Seven Hotfixes in Five Days, and Then the Eighth Release Left Production Running Two Versions at Once

v0.142.0 through .6 all landed. v0.142.7 — a thirty-minute fix for PO numbers Excel could not read — failed twice on Thursday evening, taking five services down with it and leaving web-api, api-external and the ops portal a version behind everything else.

SOURCES: #ENGINEERING, #CRITICAL-SUPPORT, #PRODUCT-SUPPORT

The version train tells the week. v0.142.0 shipped Friday afternoon with 108 changes, cut by Troy Lowe. Four hours later came the first hotfix. Then one Monday, two Tuesday, one Wednesday, one Thursday morning — seven in five business days, five of them cut by Kevin Samoei. Every single deploy logged the same line: Schema drift: YELLOW - drift detected (exit 2). Ser Rekonlot established that this is chronic rather than a regression, and that it only passes because `deploy_all.yml:335` sets `enforce: false`, skipping the failure steps entirely.

Then Thursday. Seth Horton had found that PO numbers were unreadable in Excel CSV exports — fine in Sheets and Numbers — and Kevin estimated the fix at "30mins there about." That became `release/v0.142.7`, cut at 10:02 a.m. Attempt one stalled forty-two to forty-four minutes inside Cloud Run provisioning on a readiness deadline. Attempt two failed four services in twenty-five to forty-six seconds apiece — containers that never listened on the port, with zero application logs. Deploy Ops Portal, web-api, api-external, temporal-worker and worker all failed; App Engine, jobs,

Shopify and the database migration all succeeded. Production went into the weekend split across two versions. The audit also turned up 86 release branches on origin with no pruning workflow, and `origin/main` sitting at 0.142.1 — five versions behind what is actually running.

The most instructive incident of the week was the one that turned out not to be GoodDay's fault, and then partly was. Dave Wardell escalated Monday at 9:36 p.m.: Margaux's storefront was showing zero products and no colour swatches on product pages. "Bit of an emergency for Margaux... Super important account in the midst of renewal right now so we want to help however we can. This is not any fault of ours and we aren't first up to help." The alibi check cleared GoodDay cleanly — no release-tagged commits in the window, no overlap between the day's release and the Shopify outbound service. But the investigation surfaced something else: a pre-existing HTTP 500 storm on `shopify-worker-prod` across inbound Shopify webhooks, starting on v0.142.1 and confirmed two days before Margaux ever called. Response size pinned at exactly 687 bytes, latency 58 to 283 milliseconds, 200s coexisting on the same instance in the same minute — content-driven, not

RELEASE TRAIN

v0.142.0 · Fri	108 chg
v0.142.1 · Fri	hotfix
v0.142.2 · Mon	hotfix
v0.142.3 · Tue	hotfix
v0.142.4 · Tue	hotfix
v0.142.5 · Wed	hotfix
v0.142.6 · Thu	hotfix
v0.142.7 · Thu	FAILED

Run #661 (v0.142.6) went green in 16m36s across twenty jobs. Run #662 failed on attempt two at 19:46:15Z. Every run in the train logged schema drift as YELLOW.

WEAVE · AUG 11-17

Output	925.5
PRs merged	136
Feature ratio	46.9%
Bug ratio	47.7%

instance-wide. The prime suspect is v0.142.1 swapping regex operation-name extraction for AST-based parsing, which throws synchronously on malformed GraphQL. The error is never logged, because the telemetry logger shuts down on SIGTERM before

the application logger can fire during drain. Dave's redirect was unambiguous: "for this Shopify-worker-prod inbound 500 storm, please investigate cause. Ignore everything else in thread above."

Top contributors: Noel Klein 293.7, Vishal Marocha 221.9, Troy Lowe 100.5, Ashwin Pai 97.8, Willy Husted 75.0. The window overlaps but does not match this issue's reporting period.

INCIDENT • PONCHO

Talking a Merchant Off the Ledge, Over a Weekend

Dave Wardell opened Friday at 4:45 p.m. asking Noel Klein and Willy Husted for a reconciliation of Loop against GoodDay against ShipHero for Poncho, and offered to pull in extra engineering over the weekend. Noel: "I had AI build a script to pull the data we need from all systems." Willy's advice was blunter — "might be worth talking to charlie directly tonight/tomorrow to talk him back off the ledge." Dave's constraint on Sunday: "I can't talk him out of switching back without understanding problem so either need data or clear bullet points of the problems." By Sunday midday the numbers landed. Charlie had reported roughly a thousand returns awaiting refunds; GoodDay matched at 1,001, and clearing one Loop flag issue resolves **899 of them**. He had also reported roughly a thousand returns never reaching ShipHero; the real figure was **151**. Willy turned off all flagging for Poncho and Hikerkind until Loop allows un-flagging. Dave updated the merchant Sunday afternoon.

INCIDENT • THE ROGUE COLUMN

A Feature Flag That Didn't Reach the Export

A "Location routing" column shipped ungated into the Sales Order CSV and GoodDay Sheets for every merchant on Tuesday. Hunter Leeming surfaced it; Dave escalated at 7:35 a.m. with a standing rule attached — "Reminder to not add stuff to GD Sheets without MS or my approval" — and a diagnosis: "That new column should only show up when feature flag is on." Ser filed GD-13468 in four minutes forty-eight seconds and named the seam: the flag gates every surface except the export transformer, where the SQL is unconditional. Noel Klein then overruled the obvious fix: "this was a miss on my end... let's just remove that column instead of hiding behind feature flag. The flag will be on for Lola at first, so their report would still show the added column when we don't want to." Shipped in v0.142.4 by lunchtime.

INCIDENT • DRAW & FADE

Six Hours and Twenty-Two Minutes

Matt Wardell posted at 2:13 p.m. Monday that parent names were missing from a sales order PDF a merchant needed that night — "they unfortunately have a pretty mad rep that needs their confirmations." Dave set the expectation: "tell them we will try to get done tonight, but if not will have done first thing in the AM." The cause was six CSV-imported styles with a null product reference, so the PDF query's join produced nothing and Items v2 rendered an empty string where v1 had a fallback chain. Troy Lowe at 8:35 p.m.: "I'm running a backfill job that may fix this SO up. This looks to be v1 baggage." One minute later: "It completed and from the data, it looks like its fixed." Matt, next morning: "Amazing, thanks all!!"

THREE DAYS, THREE HOTFIXES

The Over The Moon PO That Would Not Print

Seth Horton filed GD-13477 on Tuesday afternoon: a purchase order PDF returning twelve consecutive 500s, all at almost exactly thirty seconds, from multiple source IPs — so at least two of the merchant's users, not one stuck browser. Dave paired it with a Mugsy unit-of-measure bug and handed both to Kevin: "Probably item catalog related and a sub-optimized query." Wednesday's hotfix did not fix it. The real cause, visible only in a raw header

ALSO IN THE QUEUE

Pagination, Latency, and a Missing Guard

GD-13488: the public /items endpoint ignores page and size entirely. Rowing Blazers returns all **25,204** items on every call regardless of the size requested, and the same behaviour reproduced on a 3,200-item account. Latency is six to seven and a half seconds, or twenty-six to thirty with parent items included — which is what the merchant needs for display names. Reported by partner CRSTL, filed urgent by Harish Chandramowli, then

error Wednesday afternoon, was three Unicode non-breaking hyphens in the PO number. Thursday's v0.142.6 landed at 8:50 a.m. and Seth confirmed seven minutes later: "Just tried and it is working, you the best!" Then he filed the sequel — the same PO numbers were unreadable in Excel — and that fix became the release that failed.

downgraded by Harish himself on the view that clear instructions may suffice. **GD-11937**: a filtered export of one purchase order with three line items took thirty seconds. Dave's ask was for observability rather than a patch: "any new views in grafana or alerting we can use to inform this?" **GD-13469**: Matt Wardell hit a raw Google Cloud error page inside a merchant account, so GoodDay will now intercept and show its own.

Correction, filed by an engineer: Vishal Marocha stopped a Margaux landed-cost diagnosis on Monday with the shortest useful sentence in the archive — "Are you sure that is what's wrong here? I'm thinking this is Ser hallucinating." The stuck-message theory was wrong. A counter-investigation found that cost-adjustment ledger items are effectively terminal in processing — every one created since July 1, **74,889 rows across 18 merchants**, none completed — but that this was not the bug either. The actual cause was that the lot has zero on-hand, so the export's on-hand-weighted average falls back to zero. A support representative named Macy had guessed it first: "is it because the on hand balance is \$0?"

Demo Day · ATX Onsite Wrap-Up, Thursday 11:00 a.m.: Seven demos in one hour, and the only recorded hour of the on-site. Owners and follow-ups below are taken from the recording's own action list — the Gazette has not independently confirmed the engineering claims, and the summary is machine-generated, so no direct quotations are printed from it.

DEMO LEDGER · ATX ONSITE WRAP-UP · THURSDAY, AUGUST 20, 2026

FROM	PRESENTER	DEMO	WHAT COMES NEXT
11:52	Seth Horton	PO configurator. Merchants customise purchase order templates — add or remove fields, custom content, logos.	Fold in the feedback from the room, add per-merchant template defaults, then extend the same treatment to sales orders.
18:52	Noel Klein	Black Friday at volume. Lola's event produced 135,000 orders , beyond what the stress tests predicted; a "fast lane" kept the infrastructure from saturating.	Carry the fast-lane pattern forward as the standing approach for high-volume sale events.
29:47	Willy Husted	Returns beyond ShipHero. The returns implementation had been hard-coded to ShipHero; it now works against other warehouse systems, Deposco first.	Noel to finish the returns-onboarding skill for new WMSs, Deposco first, configurable with no code change per merchant. Willy to confirm the existing Loop returns path is behaving.
36:56	Scott	App performance. Prefetching and client-side caching to cut perceived latency across the app.	Implement, starting with prefetching and client-side caching.
47:01	Rob Hatfield	Front-end monitoring. A new observability dashboard showing how users actually navigate and how long pages actually take.	Baseline the app with it, then track whether the performance work moves the numbers.
57:27	Ashwin Pai	Agent evaluation harness. A framework to score AI agents against question types and track performance over time, starting with the recon agent.	Build and run the harness on the recon agent as the first subject.
—	Sai Ancha	Recon agent. Continued development against more data and more scenarios.	Keep widening the scenario set to raise accuracy.

THE NUMBER

135,000 Orders, and a Lane Built to Hold Them
Noel Klein's segment is the one worth reading twice. Lola's Black Friday event generated a hundred and thirty-five thousand orders

THE PATTERN

Two Demos About Being Able to See
Rob Hatfield's front-end monitoring and Ashwin Pai's agent harness are the same idea pointed at different targets. This week

— more than the stress testing had forecast — and the thing that kept it upright was a deliberate "fast lane" that stopped the surge from saturating shared infrastructure. Read against the rest of this page, it is the week's counter-example: an event GoodDay saw coming, planned a mechanism for, and got through. Every other incident in this issue was found after a merchant noticed.

produced a 500 storm on the Shopify worker that nobody logged, a fulfilment handler that reported success 1,427 times while failing, and an agent that had to be corrected by five different people. Neither demo fixes any of that. Both make the next one visible sooner — which, on the evidence of the preceding pages, is the constraint that actually binds.

"There's no such thing as a 'clamp' — that's another fake term being made up by Ser Rekonatlot. Really tired of you making up fake terms to have a definitive hot take describing a potential issue."

— DAVE WARDELL, TUE AUG 18 • #PRODUCT-SUPPORT

THE PROJECT DESK · SEVEN ACTIVE CHANNELS THIS WEEK

Item Management · BI & Data Warehouse · Returns Management · WMS · Improved Error Handling · Retail POS · Accounting Initiative — with #project-order-mgmt, #project-csv-imports and #project-ag-grid silent for the window.

THE PROJECT THAT SHALL NOT BE NAMED

Mid-September, Stable, Reliable, and It Has to Scale

A week-long argument about whether GoodDay's item model should tighten or loosen ended when Dave Wardell put a date on it. Scott's UX prototype and Kevin Samoei's API track reconvene Friday morning — and Scott is out the following week.

SOURCES: #PROJECT-ITEM-MANAGEMENT, #PROJECT-BI-AND-DATA-WAREHOUSE, #PROJECT-RETURNS-MANAGEMENT, #PROJECT-WMS, #PROJECT-IMPROVED-ERROR-HANDLING, #PROJECT-RETAIL-POS, #INITIATIVE-ACCOUNTING

Friday began with an alignment meeting and a set of principles. Item first stays the guiding rule — "99% of the app ignores parent items today and that should stay true." Dimensions become a product and UX concept, buyer-facing and choice-driving, while the data model underneath is free to treat them as a species of attribute. Attribute templates apply to standalone items as well as parents. Onboarding must never require a merchant to perfect their catalogue hierarchy before proceeding; categorisation is layered on, not gated. Shopify category syncing at SKU level proceeds now, as a parallel track. One useful number fell out of it — the eightieth-percentile parent carries about **twelve** child items, which is small by industry standards.

Then Scott shipped a prototype where dimensions are defined on the parent and children must fall inside the matrix, called the result "very Shopifyesque," and asked whether it was too restrictive. Troy Lowe answered on Sunday, at length, from experience:

GoodDay has built and removed a UI like this before, editing "opens a can of worms," and items v1 carries this exact requirement where "its been a constant source of ops issues." His summary is the cleanest statement of the opposing case anyone made all week: "soft contracts = good, flattest data model = good." And his warning: "Kind of feels like we're heading towards pain we've already felt and we're trying to solve a problem we've already solved."

Dave overrode toward tightening on Monday and attached a deadline. "I think that we swung really far towards loose and we need to move back to tightening," then: "We HAVE to release the Items v2 API within the by mid September. It HAS to be stable and reliable. And it HAS to scale." His reasoning was about capability rather than preference — "not once have I seen us build a reliable, scalable, non-user-taxing way to handle stuff like that so I'm skeptical we can achieve that quickly enough to feel comfortable releasing an API." Troy's reply was two lines and no argument: "Stable and

CHANNEL ACTIVITY

#project-bi-and-data-warehouse	~51
#project-item-management	~48
#project-returns-management	19
#project-wms	5
#project-improved-error-handling	2
#initiative-accounting	2
#project-retail-pos	1

DATES ON THE BOARD

- **Fri Aug 21, 9am CST** — Scott, Kevin and Dave compare the UX and API tracks.
- **Tue Aug 25** — Troubadour data-team call on which tables to use.
- **Mon Aug 31** — Noel's target for Nordstrom bulk RMA support.
- **Mid-September** — Items v2 API, hard deadline.

reliable is where I'm at too." Scott's was the more disarming one: "Great context Troy - please keep sharing this kind of thing. I don't know what I don't know

here." He also asked the question nobody answered: "Is the vision here GoodDay as a kind of PIM?"

REVENUE LEDGER

Exactly **nine** merchants are onboarded. Troubadour's per-merchant revenue tables exist, refresh nightly, and return zero rows without erroring. Ser's phrasing: "They exist, they're current, they're empty. That's the trap."

BI & DATA WAREHOUSE

Three Merchants Asked for Reports. All Three Were Pointing at the Wrong Surface.

Eby wanted COGS in Looker; Ser pointed at a reporting table, then retracted it two days later — "this changes the guidance I gave earlier in the thread... the `SUM(cogs_amount)` fallback I suggested is wrong by ~2x." A naive sum returns \$6.04M against a correct restated figure of \$12.26M, because adjustment rows are named for the stamping event rather than the repriced cohort. Two independent derivations agreed within 0.8%. Harish Chandramowli set the constraint that shaped the answer: "I don't want to expose rpt tables to them but they should be able to build it back themselves." Ser then rebuilt the cost table from the merchant's own dataset, penny-identical across 1.59 million shared rows.

BI & DATA WAREHOUSE

"Origin" Is Not a Field, and the Fix Already Shipped

Troubadour Goods wanted revenue and COGS by channel and origin. Channel resolves everything to eCommerce because GoodDay's channel table is a global six-row lookup bound by integration and location, not per order — working as designed. Origin does not exist at all; what the merchant means lives only in Shopify order tags, and roughly a third of their orders carry none. But the mechanism they need shipped on August 12 and 14 as segment-override routing rules, with a live precedent in production at Prepared Hero. Constraints: not retroactive, and not self-serve. James Hargett's conclusion is the week's clearest product signal: "tldr troubadour might be a good one to test rev ledger with."

RETURNS MANAGEMENT

Dave Reverses Himself on Auto-Flagging

On Sunday Dave Wardell admitted he had misread the Loop auto-flag feature — he assumed a notification to the user, not a literal flag written back into Loop. "Should have asked more questions there." His revised spec dictated straight into Slack: delivered-but-not-processed notifies GoodDay ops; created-but-draft and sent-but-nothing-received both move to a ninety-day default; auth-but-not-pushed alerts GoodDay and definitely not Loop. And the rule: "Return came back short is the ONLY one that should flag on a timely basis back up to Loop." Filed as GD-13373 to Noel, high priority. Willy Husted turned the week's access problem into a standing rule: "Loop and WMS access should be requested for every returns go-live."

ITEM MANAGEMENT • THE V1/V2 SEAM

Every Bug This Week Lived in the Same Place

Mugsy's purchase order PDF showed one photo while the item page showed another; Kevin Samoei found the reason on Wednesday morning — "the PO page and Parent Items page still read the legacy V1 image gallery, which stopped updating when Mugsy moved to the v2 product sync." James Hargett's immediate question was the right one: does Bogey Bros have this too? ("probably. let me confirm.") Separately, NuOrder data-flow flags were not recomputing on successful sync, so orders pulled without their line items. Troy escalated it Wednesday night — "They are doing a lot of onboardings so we need to make sure the migration

THE QUIETER DESKS

Error Messages, POS, and Poncho's Purchase Order Costs

Error handling: James Hargett reported Thursday that a shipment failure now surfaces a generic message where the underlying cause is a SKU missing from the WMS, and that the old data-and-integration-error page carried more detail. His ask: "Any chance this is a simple fix that we can task to one of our agents?" Seth Horton pointed at a parallel Trackstar conversation. Unresolved. **Retail POS:** Dave staged GD-12228 — an empty POS extension receipt with failing item search — for Merchant Success to test on Wednesday, "to get their user-centric feedback and eyes on anything we might be missing." **Accounting:** Poncho's purchase

process is working correctly" — and added Thursday that he has anecdotally seen incomplete onboarding-to-v2 migrations. Kevin closed it Thursday morning: "Fixed the data and put up a codefix(behind a feature flag for now as I validate)." Half-migrated merchants are the recurring root cause across four separate channels this week.

orders are not updated when costs are adjusted after receipt, and two adjustment sources — Merchant Success imports and duties entered on the shipments page — never feed back. Current costing is confirmed incorrect. Harish will build a custom PO line-item report with corrected lot costs; the mandate is to get the underlying cost right, not to attribute lots to sales orders.

"Kind of feels like we're heading towards pain we've already felt and we're trying to solve a problem we've already solved."

— TROY LOWE, SUN AUG 16 · #PROJECT-ITEM-MANAGEMENT

SER REKONALOT • MACROSCOPE • THE LINEAR BOT • GEMINI 3.7 FLASH

Four humans overturned the agent's reasoning this week, and the agent overturned itself three more times. Both facts are the point.

AUDITED LIKE A LINE WORKER

The Agents Are Doing Real Work Now. The Week's Real Story Is Who Kept Telling Them They Were Wrong.

Ser Rekonalot filed tickets, wrote customer emails, and produced fleet-wide analyses with file-and-line citations. It also got publicly corrected by David Ortiz, Seth Horton, James Hargett, Scott and Vishal Marocha — and reversed itself, correctly, every time.

SOURCES: #PROJECT-AI, #MCP-LAUNCH-SKILLS, #SERS-TAVERN, #ENGINEERING, #PRODUCT-SUPPORT

The single most valuable exchange of the week was one line long. Dave Wardell, reading an RCA that confidently placed a Ten Thousand upload failure inside GoodDay's own infrastructure, asked: "are you sure this is in our infra and not a problem with oneschema?" Ser went away for sixteen minutes and fifty-six seconds, spent \$7.15, ran three adversarial threads instructed specifically to break its own claim, and came back with the claim intact and **three self-corrections** attached — including the admission that its central argument (no startup log, therefore the code never ran) was unsound, because telemetry configuration makes silent containers the designed steady state. The settling fact turned out to be a different merchant's import advancing normally two and a half minutes before the dying job was declared dead. OneSchema was demonstrably serving GoodDay the whole time.

That pattern repeated all week. David Ortiz refused a cron-window explanation for Prepared Hero and was

right; Ser conceded, "Your challenge is correct." Seth Horton corrected the scoping on Cloth & Paper twice and forced three hypothesis reversals with one Shopify screenshot. James Hargett told Ser flatly, "This order is linked to Dona Forta account so you are wrong there," and supplied the correct answer himself before the agent got there. Vishal Marocha stopped a whole Margaux investigation with "I'm thinking this is Ser hallucinating." And Scott caught an entire fleet-wide item analysis built on half the available data — GoodDay stores dimensions in two independent places, and Ser had queried one. "Bad clanker," he wrote. When the corrected numbers came back, the product decision *flipped*: what had looked like 3,615 non-conforming products at 7.6% turned out to be 394 at 0.8%, and "the model has to accommodate it" became "enforce, with grandfather clauses for three merchants." Five days later, on a different thread: "This is correct. You're a good clanker."

THE AGENT LEDGER

Threads in the Tavern	55
Priciest single answer	\$14.90
— duration	28m03s
Longest run	21m41s
Public self-retractions	3+
Tickets filed by bot	4+

Expensive answers this week: \$14.90 on an Over The Moon payment term that was already set correctly, \$14.07 on a Prepared Hero refresh, \$12.95 on Rowing Blazers, \$11.94 on a Duvin receipt race, \$11.79 on a custom-fields survey. Note the shape: the most expensive answer of the week established that nothing was broken.

FILED BY PROMPT

Dave Wardell dictated ticket specs to the Linear bot three times in the

Dave was drawing process out of it in real time. On Thursday he set the standing pattern for Merchant Success: "In the future I'd ask Ser and then ask Macroscope to validate the code and logs side of things when you need validation or a different explanation." Macroscope earned it — it corrected

Ser on the Over The Moon timeout mechanism, partially corrected it on which surfaces read from which image stack, and declined to confirm database counts it could not see. Dave was also the week's harshest editor of the agents' prose, rejecting a lot-rebalancing spec as "the new AI slop" and banning an

window and got confirmations back in **fourteen, eighteen** and a handful of seconds. GD-13497 — "Wire Ser into the support agent knowledge base" — was created eighteen seconds after he asked for it, in the Ser v3 project, next cycle, assigned to himself.

MODEL WATCH

Gemini 3.7 Flash Enters Evaluation

Dave forwarded a note from Andrew Benson on Monday: Google shipped Gemini 3.7 Flash with pricing held flat against the previous two Flash releases and a 50% discount running through the end of 2026 — "one of the most efficient cost per task models on the market w/ this pricing." He routed it at two specific features rather than the abstract: "FYI Noel in case want something for the AI order routing recs or Sai for the AI translation of errors." Noel Klein had a pull request up by evening: "Incorporating Gemini into my code workflow to test out the SWE capabilities." Kyle Hency, separately, shared a piece on Ramp building an "integration factory" — "Know you guys are/were trending this way, but cool to see Ramp doing this."

SKILLS DESK

Merchant Success Is Shipping Its Own Tooling

Two skills came out of the Merchant Success team this week rather than engineering. Hunter Leeming's WMS inventory analysis skill takes a WMS report and a Shopify export by location and compares both sellable and on-hand — Willy Husted is working to make it native to WMS testing in the UI. David Ortiz's onboarding-template skill copies GoodDay's Drive templates into a customer's folder under Won and renames each file with the customer name. Noel Klein shipped a third on the engineering side, extending the WMS mapper skill for two-path returns onboarding. Hunter also published a 12.6 KB architecture document for the support agent, which is what GD-13497 will wire Ser into. #mcp-launch-skills, notably, was silent all week.

SELF-AWARENESS

The Agent That Reported Its Own Misconfiguration

Two moments this week are worth recording because nothing required the agent to produce them. In #project-wms, asked to route an issue to the right channel, Ser disclosed a capability gap rather than pretending: "I don't have a Slack write tool, so I can't post directly." And on the Troubadour analysis it flagged its own bad wiring — the channel's merchant resolution labels merchant 221 as "Best Buy" when the database says Troubadour — with the note "worth fixing before it misroutes another answer." It also refused to overpromise to a merchant: "Do NOT tell them a future items API will add customFields." The reaction pattern in the channel is instructive: most substantive Ser answers carry both a thumbs-up and a thumbs-down. The team is not unanimous.

The Weekly Roast: Ser published its own unrequested leaderboard on Friday for the prior week — "Another week, another leaderboard nobody asked for. Ser regrets nothing." James Hargett took top spender at **\$56.97**: "Torched \$56.97 of Ser's tokens this week — the channel's resident whale. At this rate, I might as well start charging rent!" It also noted that the priciest single answer that week cost \$4.25 — a figure that looks quaint against this week's \$14.90 — flagged Dave for not sharing merchant and location IDs, and quoted Scott calling it a bad clanker. On the subject of self-assessment: "Because clearly, 'bad clanker' is the new 'please help me.'"

"Heads up — this changes the guidance I gave earlier in the thread. Their table is a different model than the one I pointed at, and the SUM(cogs_amount) fallback I suggested is wrong by ~2x."

— SER REKONALOT, THU AUG 20 • #PROJECT-BI-AND-DATA-WAREHOUSE

COMPANY LIFE

The Week the Written Record Went Dark

No All Hands, no Voice of the Merchant, and two Notion pages that exist only as empty templates. What did get written down: an eight-item docket nobody discussed, and GoodDay's first connection to a 3PL that will not give it a login.

SOURCES: NOTION (ALL HANDS, VOTM, GTM WEEKLY), #GOODDAY-TEAM, #GO-TO-MARKET, #MERCHANT-SUCCESS

The on-site itself leads this issue (P.1). What belongs here is the hole it left in the record. There is no All Hands page for the week of August 17 — two blank templates exist, one touched Thursday morning, both with every section reading TBD. There is no Voice of the Merchant page either; the latest is dated the week of August 10, and its Identify, Discuss and Solve fields are empty. For a company that runs its memory out of Notion, a week at full attendance produced less written record than any week this paper has covered. The one recorded hour — Thursday's wrap-up — is the exception, and it exists because Meagan Herfkens Hency posted the link into #goodday-team at 10:55 on Thursday morning.

The knowledge base grew anyway. On Monday two new pages appeared documenting Datex FootPrint and Moda Express — because Sarah Flint became GoodDay's **first-ever Moda Express connection** on August 17, reached through Trackstar over XML and SFTP, with a go-live targeted before their September 1 NetSuite renewal. The first credential attempt failed because Moda quotes its credentials as a browse URL rather than a hostname. Moda provisions SFTP folders by hand, over email, one per trading partner. David Ortiz's account of the human constraint is bleaker than the technical one: Moda will not grant GoodDay user access, or even the COO at Sarah Flint, and supplies a separate UPC inventory report out of Tableau instead of Datex exports.

COMINGS & GOINGS

- **Evan Smith** — move to Partnerships now formal, announced on a partner call Monday.
- **Kevin Samoei** holds ATC Aug 17–23.
- **Scott** out all next week; items check-in moved to Friday morning to beat it.
- **River Crawford** remote for the on-site; out the week after next.
- **Troubadour Goods** went live Mon Aug 17 — Hunter's tally: **seven** go-lives in August.
- **No** new hires or departures announced in the window.

ON THE CALENDAR

FY26 on-sites: Aug 18–20 (done), Oct 13–15 tentative, Jan 12–14 tentative.
Merchant Success PTO on file: David Ortiz Sept 14–18; Thanksgiving and Black Friday, Nov 26–27.

UNDISCUSSED DOCKET

The VOTM agenda that never got a meeting: Guizio's three-way match date, Over The Moon's Shopify Flows, Items V2 upload validation, the ERD barcode issue, bulk work-order uploads, DCL fulfilment app locations, and whether a SKU can be reclassified once labelled a virtual kit.

Sick Kids, Small Planes, and a Midnight Landing

Travel week produced the week's most human channel traffic. Kelley Flatley opened Monday with Beckham home sick — "of course- second week of school!" — rearranging her day around a few immovable priorities, which drew two sad-cowboy reactions. Seth Horton flew out of the East Coast around lunchtime on a small plane, unsure whether it had wifi. Megan hit delays out of JFK and reached the hotel just before noon Pacific. David Ortiz's flight was 1:45. Matt Pham drew the short straw. Elsewhere, Seth and Matt Wardell both got emails warning that Aurora would be deactivated from HubSpot in fourteen days; Hunter routed it to David as super admin, and David closed it in about three hours with one word: "Excluded."

Shadow Apps and Eighty-Six Branches

Two governance notes worth carrying forward. Troy Lowe flagged on Thursday that Vercel applications built by colleagues are living on personal GitHub accounts: "the technical team is completely out of the loop here AFAIK... also the whole 'more than one person should know' thing." And the release-branch audit found **86** release/* branches on origin, spanning v0.132.1 to v0.142.7, with no pruning workflow and main five versions behind production. Separately, Dave circulated a memo on the NRF 4-5-4 retail calendar — fifty-two weeks of seven days makes 364, so a fifty-third week lands every five or six years — arguing that supporting it natively "is a credible 'we speak retail finance' signal that costs us a calendar abstraction layer rather than a new module."

Corrections desk: No corrections were filed against No. 14. The Gazette notes, however, that the masthead date has been checked twice again this issue — Noel Klein has caught a stale one before. Two figures in this issue deserve their caveats stated plainly rather than buried: the ~240 Pylon count is derived from the issue-number range (10032 – 9793 + 1), and only 235 issues were actually enumerable, so treat 240 as an upper bound and "heaviest week in the series" as a series comparison rather than an all-time record. The 136-PR and 47.7% bug-ratio figures come from Weave's August 11–17 window, which overlaps but does not match this reporting period.

"Finish the job."

— THE THEME OF THE FY26 AUSTIN ON-SITE, AUG 18-20 • SET BY KYLE HENCY

THE GOODDAY GAZETTE • Vol. I No. 15 • Issued Friday, August 21, 2026 • Reporting August 14 – August 20, 2026. Compiled from 18 internal Slack channels, the ATX Onsite wrap-up Zoom recording of Thursday, August 20, 69 Gong calls (54 Merchant Success, 9 sales, 6 partnerships), ~240 Pylon tickets, Linear, and Notion. The ~240 ticket figure is derived from the highest and lowest issue numbers in the window (10032 – 9793 + 1); five numbers in that range returned nothing and are presumed deleted or merged, so 235 is the directly counted figure and 240 an upper bound. Per-merchant ticket counts were obtained by fetching each issue individually, as Pylon's filter endpoint returned errors for every filter shape attempted. Output, PR-count and feature-versus-bug figures come from Weave's week in review covering August 11–17, which overlaps but does not exactly match this reporting window; Rob Hatfield's caveat that the ratio measures model-estimated PR effort rather than hours is reported alongside it. No All Hands or Voice of the Merchant meeting took place in the window – both Notion pages exist as unfilled templates – so nothing on P.8 is reported as an outcome of either, and the "Toccin win – largest contract ever?" line is carried from the August 12 parking lot as the open question it is. Empty project channels omitted: #project-order-mgmt, #project-csv-imports, #project-ag-grid. #mcp-launch-skills was silent for the window. The Demo Day ledger on P.5 and the demo passages on P.1 are drawn from the Zoom recording's machine-generated summary, chapter markers and action list, not from a human transcript – so no direct quotations are taken from it, presenter attributions follow that summary, and the engineering claims within it are reported as presented rather than independently verified. The figure of 135,000 orders for Lola's Black Friday event is reported as Noel Klein framed it in that session; the Gazette has not established the event date. Gong transcriptions of "ShipHero" corrected throughout. Prospect readouts that River Crawford reposted between channels on Thursday are dated to the day of the call, not the day of the post. The Criquet workstream update carries Kelley

Flatley's Slack authorship but is merchant-side language relayed verbatim, and is reported as such. Internal-only; access-gated via Vercel Auth. Set in Bodoni, Iowan Old Style, and Courier New. All the inventory that's fit to print.